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WEST BENGAL

West Bengal has witnessed prolonged tensions between Raj Bhavan and the state government. During Jagdeep Dhankhar's tenure as governor, frequent clashes occurred over administrative decisions and university appointments. His successor, **C.V. Ananda Bose,** continued this trend, notably announcing a "social boycott" of CM **Mamata Banerjee** amid protests over the RG Kar incident. The discord extended to the appointment of vice-chancellors in universities. In January 2025, the SC granted Bose more time to finalise appointments, emphasising transparency and fairness in the process.

BOTH C.V. ANANDA BOSE AND HIS PREDECESSOR JAGDEEP DHANKHAR HAVE CLASHED WITH MAMATA BANERJEE

JAMMU & KASHMIR

In October 2024, after the first assembly election since the revocation of Jammu and Kashmir's special status in 2019, **Omar Abdullah**'s National Conference-led alliance came to power. But significant powers, including control over police and bureaucratic appointments, remain with Lieutenant Governor **Manoj Sinha**, a central appointee. The turf war came to a head on April 1, when LG Sinha ordered the transfer of 48 officials without consulting the chief minister. The LG further rejected Abdullah's bid to restore a holiday honouring Sheikh Abdullah and extended varsity vice-chancellors' terms. Security decisions, too, are made without the CM's input. The disconnect proved deadly in January 2025, when 17 died in Rajouri from a sudden illness due to delayed emergency response—caught between divided authority and bureaucratic inertia.

KARNATAKA

In Karnataka, ties between CM **Siddaramaiah** and governor **Thaawarchand Gehlot** soured in August 2024 after Gehlot sanctioned a probe into corruption allegations against Siddaramaiah over the allotment of land to his wife. The Karnataka HC cleared the way for a Lokayukta investigation. In response, the state government tried to curb the governor's powers, passing a bill that made the CM chancellor of the Rural Development and Panchayat Raj University, replacing Gehlot. The standoff deepened when Gehlot referred to the President an amendment to the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act, which reserved 4 per cent of public works contracts for Muslims.

GOVERNOR GEHLOT SANCTIONED A CORRUPTION PROBE AGAINST CM SIDDARAMAIAH, TRIGGERING GOVERNOR-STATE STRIFE

instance, claimed the authority to dismiss a minister. In Tamil Nadu, Governor Ravi unilaterally sacked a minister arrested on corruption charges—though he later reversed the decision—and refused to reinstate another minister despite the Supreme Court having suspended his conviction in a corruption case. This when as constitutional expert PDT Achary points out, "Article 164 says that the CM is appointed by the governor and other ministers are appointed on the advice of the CM. So, the governor cannot remove a minister without the advice of the CM."



"Across the world, politics has become divisive. The governor-state government conflict are reflective of this"

MAHESH JETHMALANI
Senior lawyer and former Rajya Sabha MP

And it is not just appointment of CMs, dismissal of government, dissolution of assembly and imposition of President's Rule that are causing governor-state frictions; the current battles revolve around determining when assemblies are convened, interference in day-to-day administration, delaying assent to bills and even making adverse comments in public. The